

systems on the Raspberry Pi, it is clear that some work better than others. The alternative options that we discuss have also been developed with the Raspberry Pi in mind but still haven't found the stability we would expect. Using the operating systems isn't undesirable, some are simply glitchy since they haven't yet been perfected. They are ideal for users who wish to experiment with the operating system interface and wish to learn on their own with no community resources. Due to the relative inexperience of these operating systems there aren't very many guidelines or communities to turn to for help. Definitely not recommended for first time users.

Android OS

Everyone has used Android operating system in one form or another. From their smartphones to tablets to even appliance tools like digital cameras - the Android OS is one of the most popular mobility device systems available. The idea of the Android OS on the Raspberry Pi makes sense given the hardware similarities between the Pi and mobile devices. As a part of the Google family of products, the Android OS is actually a Linux distro designed for mobile systems. It is very versatile and fast with thousands of applications and tools all ready to be used. The Android OS enjoys a vibrant community of developers keep improving and evolving the platform. However, due to its design for smartphones, it can prove to be overwhelming for the Raspberry Pi.

As we discussed in the early chapters - the Raspberry Pi is actually less powerful in hardware terms, when compared to most smartphones and tablets on the market. This makes the task of redesigning the Android OS for a far more light-weight device sort of a challenge. The installation is painless but the stability on the Pi is still uncertain. The development work on the Android OS is dormant or slow at best, with no major push for finding an effective port to the Pi. But it is still an interesting choice in certain multi-Pi board projects which collectively can support the demands of the operating system.

Pidora

The Pidora OS is a reworked Fedora distro for the Raspberry Pi which uses features from Fedora 20. The latest version of Pidora is customised for the ARMv6 architecture, with a ARMv7 version due for release. Pidora has a well designed user interface which works well on the Pi with all its features in tact. Unfortunately, it is not as fast as Raspbian or Arch Linux due